

**ANTH 202-Archaeology: Our Human Past
FALL 2026 - University of Southern California**

Instructor: Dr. Tracie Mayfield
Email: tracie.mayfield@usc.edu



**FAQs on
pages 2 & 3**

Meeting with the Instructor:

- Arrive early to your lab/discussion section or stay a few minutes late for quick questions/conversations.
- Speak with the instructor during 'study & research' time, during Tuesday and Thursday lecture sessions.
- Email the instructor directly to schedule a zoom meeting.
 - **Book early!** Open time slots (6-8 thirty-minute sessions each week) are usually filled at least week in advance.
 - OFFICE HOURS ZOOM LINK:
 - <https://usc.zoom.us/j/267643908?pwd=d2E2T2Y2NzJteHFVMWozU91S2RRdz09>
 - Meeting ID: 267 643 908 - Password: 029421
 - **No worries if you need to cancel once you have booked a spot!!!** ...but please do so prior to your scheduled meeting day/time so the time slot can open up for another student who may need it.

LAB SECTIONS ("discussion sections"): Tuesdays 8am, 9am, 10am, 11am (GFS 223)

LECTURE SESSIONS: Tuesdays & Thursdays 2pm-3:20pm (GFS 106)

Why the long syllabus??? The following document is more of a guidebook than a traditional syllabus. Students and professors have a very different work schedules and I want you to have access to as much information as possible...so if you are working late at night, you can find the answers you need instead of waiting until the next day for me to get back with you. **Please use this document and the other informational documents in the CONTENT section of Brightspace** (e.g. the final paper instructions, examples of "A" range final papers from past semesters, grading rubrics/grading categories, etc.) **to better understand the course content, assignment instructions, and grading criteria.**

COURSE DESCRIPTION

Throughout this course, students will **explore the human past through multiple analytical perspectives while examining diverse forms of evidence, including artifacts and material culture, natural and built environments, documentary and oral records, and the social, economic, political, and cultural contexts that shaped human societies.** Students will also examine issues of cultural heritage, stewardship, preservation, and public access to archaeological sites, collections, and historical landscapes. **Using both qualitative and quantitative data, students will integrate inductive and deductive approaches to investigate the past and produce well-supported, evidence-based interpretations.**

Students will be **introduced to the theories, methods, and methodologies that guide archaeological research while learning how archaeologists define research problems, formulate research questions, design investigations, develop sampling strategies, and collect, analyze, and interpret data.** Particular emphasis will be placed on understanding how methodological decisions shape research outcomes and influence interpretation.

Although archaeology provides the framework for this course, **students will develop transferable analytical skills** -including critical thinking, evidence evaluation, pattern recognition, research design, and evidence-based decision making- that are **valuable across academic disciplines and professional fields and serve as the foundation for upper-division and specialized coursework for archaeology and anthropology majors and minors.**

COURSE OVERVIEW

This course **introduces students to the discipline of archaeology through a global survey of archaeological discoveries, research projects, and case studies spanning the earliest human societies to the present.** Students will examine the historical development of archaeology from its origins in antiquarianism to the interdisciplinary, scientifically informed, and community-engaged approaches that characterize the field today. Along the way, they will **become familiar with the major theories, methods, analytical techniques, and research questions that define contemporary archaeological practice and provide the foundation for more advanced study in archaeology, anthropology, and heritage studies.**

Equally important, the course emphasizes the **development of transferable analytical skills** that extend far beyond archaeology. Students learn how to **formulate research questions, evaluate the quality and limitations of evidence, recognize patterns, integrate multiple sources of information, assess competing interpretations, and construct evidence-based arguments.** These approaches to critical thinking, problem solving, and decision-making are applicable across disciplines and professional settings, providing students with **intellectual tools that can be used to investigate complex questions in the natural sciences, social sciences, humanities, business, public policy, law, medicine, and many other fields.**

By exploring the remarkable diversity of human societies across time and space, the course develops an **understanding of how material culture, landscapes, and human behavior are interconnected.** Drawing on concepts and methods from anthropology, history, geology, geography, ecology, economics, spatial sciences, and other disciplines, **archaeology provides a unique framework for investigating how people lived, adapted, interacted, and transformed their worlds.** Students will examine how archaeologists use artifacts, architecture, environmental evidence, landscapes, oral histories, and historical records to reconstruct everyday life in the past.

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FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

- **When are your office hours & how can I set up a one-on-one meeting with you?**
 - See the first page of this document.
- **Will classes be recorded?**
 - **No, classes will not be recorded.** If you miss a class, you will need to get notes from a fellow classmate and utilize the information posted in the CONTENT section of Brightspace.
- **Can I attend any of the available weekly lab (discussion) sections or do I have to attend the lab section to which I was assigned?**
 - You must attend your assigned weekly lab section or you will not receive participation/attendance credit for the class. But, some exceptions are allowed on a case-by-case basis, if you contact the instructor at least 24 hours in advance and receive permission to attend another lab section. In your email, you should note why you need to participate in an alternate discussion section (e.g. job interview, student club event, etc.) and which lab section you would like to attend.
- **If I am close to the next letter grade (e.g. 89.1) after the final exam, can you bump my grade to the next letter grade (e.g. B+ to an A-)?**
 - Maybe! I will automatically take a look at all grades that meet the following criteria and will bump your grade if you have 1) completed and submitted the extra credit assignment¹ and received a 90% or above, 2) participated in class discussions & exercises in the spirit in which they were designed and added value to your fellow students' learning experiences, 3) turned in all of your assignments on time, 4) attended more than the minimum number of classes required for the course. If you meet these criteria, then yes, I will bump your grade; if not, then no, I will not bump your grade.
 - **Note that unless there is a problem with your grade (e.g. a grade was keyed into Brightspace incorrectly), you should not contact the Instructor about changing your final course grade.**
 - **NOTE: If you contact me about bumping your grade, I will not consider bumping your grade, even if you have met the criteria above.**
- **If I am taking the course Pass/No Pass, do I need to complete all the assignments?**
 - Yes and No, as per USC policy, you MUST TAKE THE FINAL EXAM, but other than that, you do not have to do all the assignments...BUT you should use a grade calculator to decide what you need to do to get the lowest grade/do the least amount of work as possible and still reach the minimum grade of 70%. A link to a grade calculator is provided below, but there are 100s of these online, so choose the one that appeals to you. **You are personally responsible for making these decisions; make sure you do not go below the P/NP grade, or you will not pass the course, no exceptions.**
- **Can I turn in assignments late and still get partial credit?**
 - Yes! See the Late Submission Policies section below.

¹ See the EXTRA CREDIT SECTION of this document for more information.

- **Are you going to post instructions for the final paper?**
 - Yes! That information is already in the CONTENT section of Brightspace (under FINAL PAPER INSTRUCTIONS & OTHER HELPFUL INFORMATION) where you can also access the grading rubric, documents on research & writing tips & tricks, and other helpful materials like examples of A-range papers from prior semesters.
- **Are you going to post a study guide for the exams?**
 - Yes! The weekly module instructions have reading & film study questions for you to use to prepare for lab sections & lecture sessions AND to study for (and take) the open book/open notes exams. Find the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS in the CONTENT section of Brightspace. Additionally, the weekly quizzes –based on the recorded lectures, readings, and films– can be used to prepare for exams.
- **Is the final exam cumulative?**
 - No! While major course themes and ideas will carry through the whole semester, the final exam is NOT cumulative and will not cover specific readings, films, or activities presented prior to the midterm exam.
- **If I join the class late, do I still need to do all the work assigned before I joined? ...will the classes I already missed be counted as absences?**
 - Yes to both questions...but, the only thing due the first 2 weeks of classes is a quiz due Friday of week 2. However, the lowest 3 quiz grades are dropped (which includes 0's) and you can miss up to 6 classes with no penalty. Take a look at the ATTENDANCE and PARTICIPATION & QUIZ SECTIONS below for more detail.
- **Are there any extra credit opportunities?**
 - Yes! See the EXTRA CREDIT SECTION below.

REQUIRED READINGS & FILMS, REQUIRED CLASS PREPARATION, AND OTHER COURSE MATERIALS

PLEASE NOTE: USC requires 100+ pages of reading a week for 200-level classes, but I can supplement with films and other types of assignments. Your read load is both comprehensive and fair with respect to your time and the University's rules.

NOTE: Lectures and class discussions & exercises will provide the backbone of the course and will complement, *but not substitute for*, assigned reading and film content. Keep up with the readings, films, and other activities listed in the weekly module instructions so that you can easily access those materials for the open book/open notes, online exams; also **utilize the reading & film study questions in the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS (under CONTENT on Brightspace).**

- Price and Feinman "Images of the Past: 9th Edition"
 - Note that while you can use the 8th addition, there are some small changes in the 9th edition. So, if you use the 8th edition, you should partner with someone in the class who has the 8th edition so you can make sure the content lines up.
- All other readings are posted in the CONTENT section of Brightspace and are noted in the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS, along with other supplementary media, links, materials, etc. needed to **complete the current week's assignments PRIOR TO ATTENDING THE CURRENT WEEK'S CLASSES.**
- **Completing the weekly preparatory assignments is ESSENTIAL, not optional.** The assigned readings and films will be crucial to your success in this course because these resources will deepen your understanding of the class materials, which **will help you participate more effectively in class discussions and do better on the exams.** It will be clear when grading your work that you have been keeping up with the materials (or not).

BRIGHTSPACE

Our main axis of communications/submissions is Brightspace. Brightspace will be used for all assignment submissions, taking exams, discussion board posts, and other communications during the course. You must have regular access to Brightspace, and it is strongly suggested that you **check and double check any submissions** to make sure those assignments have been posted by the due date/time.

- **NOTE:** Submit your work; and then log out and back in to make sure your submission posted...every time. You are responsible for submissions. If something happens and you submitted your work and it does not show up for some reason, be able to produce proof of timeliness in some fashion (e.g. a screen shot or pic of the last time you worked on the document) and email the instructor asap, when you realize there was an issue.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- (1) to provide students with a practical working knowledge of **archaeological data collection methods and the types of data used by archaeologists**, including materials, landscape and spatial information, written documents, and oral histories;
- (2) to **introduce students to the intellectual AND practical challenges presented by archaeological and ethnographic research**, including producing a research design, interpreting multiple lines of evidence from variable data sources, integrating documentary and oral records with archaeological information, identifying data problematics, working with local communities, and the need to think creatively and flexibly as new information is recovered during research;
- (3) to **apply theory and methods of social analysis from archaeology, anthropology, and history** in order to study human behavior and lived experiences in variable economic, political, cultural, gendered, and social settings;
- (4) to **understand the nature of empirical evidence** and assess the usefulness of qualitative and quantitative evidence in explaining specific social phenomena; and
- (5) to **demonstrate an understanding of the interplay between human action** and sociocultural organization, institutions, and use of materials and space, over time.
- (6) to **design and produce an original analytical research paper** using the anthropological and archaeological toolkits.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

Upon the successful completion of course, students will be able to:

- Articulate basic history, theories, methods, and aims of modern archaeology and be able to apply anthropological inquiry to archaeological problems.
- Learn how to make original, archaeologically based arguments about the past, supported by scholarly and material evidence to better understand human behavior.
- Understand the different elements of archaeological study and the relationships between these elements.
- Gather and utilize multiple lines of evidence, in order to better explain social, spatial, and material phenomena.
- Demonstrate an understanding of the interplay between human behavior, the built and natural environments, materiality, and consumer behavior within variable social, political, and cultural settings.
- Appreciate how archaeologists use archaeological and ethnographic data and historical information in combination to produce holistic analyses and interpretations.
- Gain a better understanding of how to critically look at the past in order to better understand the present and make cogent predictions about the future; a skill useful in any industry or organization.
- Acquire transferable skills, such as: recognizing the importance of leveraging internal advice and understanding the value of constructive criticism; designing & producing (and pitching!) an original project; and applying newly gained knowledge to advanced or novel datasets.

PREREQUISITE/S

There are no prerequisites for this course.

RECOMMENDED PREPARATION

Before the Course/During the First Week of the Course: Begin thinking about the different spaces you move through, throughout your day...what do you wear in certain settings? ...what do you do when you enter different spaces? ...what objects do you use for different activities and with whom do you do those activities? ...what kind of language do you use, and when? ...what did you eat for lunch and with whom(?) or did you eat lunch(?), why did you make those decisions? Be aware of how, with whom, when, and with what...you move through your daily life and how and why these things are the same or different than other people. These are the types of data we will seek to understand through archaeology.

During the Course: It is required that you complete all of the weekly readings and watch the assigned films before the week's classes begin. The readings and films assigned for the week will be used as the foundations for that week's lectures, discussions, and other activities.

GRADING SCALE

A 100-94	C+ 79.99-77	D- 63.99-60**
A- 93.99-90	C 76.99-74	F <59.99
B+ 89.99-87	C- 73.99-70*	
B 86.99-84	D+ 69.99-67	* minimum Pass (P/NP)
B- 83.99-80	D 66.99-64	** minimum for course credit

ASSIGNMENTS

GRADE CALCULATOR LINK: <https://www.rapidtables.com/calc/grade/grade-calculator.html>

attendance and participation	15%
USC Archaeology Center field trip	2%
weekly quizzes	8%
midterm exam	20%
final exam	20%
analytical case study-Research Design Worksheet 1 (TOPIC)	1%
analytical case study-Peer Review 1 (TOPIC)	2%
analytical case study-Research Design Worksheet 2 (opening paragraph and bibliography)	1%
analytical case study-Peer Review 2 (opening paragraph and bibliography)	2%
analytical case study-Final Paper	29%
	100%

- 1) **15% Attendance and Participation** – attend 24 classes (of the 30 available) for full credit.
 - You can miss a total of 6 classes without any penalty. You can miss class for any reason, which includes illness, emergencies, just not wanting to come to class that day, or even if friends are coming to LA and you want to do some surfing. **ALL ABSENCES -up to 6- are excused and are treated the same; and you do not have to turn in any paperwork or let me know you won't be in class.** But, **if you miss more than 6 classes for any reason**, each additional absence will be a deduction of (approximately) 5 points from your attendance and participation grade, which equals (approximately) ½ of a point off your final course grade. If you want to make up some points from missing more than 6 classes, you can do the extra credit assignment...see the EXTRA CREDIT SECTION below.
 - If you have a situation come up that will require that you miss more than 9 classes -which would equal missing 3 weeks of classes, I urge you to get ahold of your advisor about dropping the course or taking an incomplete and finishing up during an upcoming semester; you simply cannot do well in the course if you cannot come to class for whatever reason that may be.

IMPORTANT! Please read...

For lecture sessions (Tu/Th 2pm-3:20pm) you will use QWICKLY (via Brightspace) to log in within the first 3 minutes of class. Please make sure to have a device with you in class that will allow you to sign in.

For lab/discussion sections, I will call roll at the beginning of class. Arriving on time for classes is important to the flow of the class and it is required. Clearly, sometime things happen and you might arrive late, but chronic lateness is unacceptable. To this end, **every 3 late arrivals will result in a 2-point deduction to your overall participation grade. No exceptions.**

- LAB SECTIONS (Tuesdays):**
 - You must have completed all the assignments in the WEEKLY INSTRUCTION MODULE prior to attending your lab section, **but you do not need to turn in anything in prior to class, unless otherwise noted**...just show up and be able to do the exercises and have the discussions outlined in the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS.
 - During lab sections, we will:
 - Have a short lecture on the week's themes and assigned materials and watch some short films.
 - Do an experiential exercise and/or have a discussion about the current week's materials and themes.

- **LECTURE SESSIONS (Tuesdays & Thursdays):**

- During lecture sessions, we will:
 - Have short lectures on the week's themes and assigned materials, and watch some short films.
 - Have 'open' time (most weeks) where you can work on your case study or the upcoming weeks' assignments...such as viewing films, reading, answering content study questions from the weekly module instructions, preparing for lab section exercises & discussions either on your own or with other students, taking the weekly quiz (which you can do with other students!)...and get help from the instructor with course content or your analytical case study (final paper).
- While **lab sections are highly structured**, **lecture sessions are generally less so - other than the short lectures**, which 1) allows for students to get real-time, individualized help from the instructor, 2) provides a space for students to work on their own to complete weekly assignments, 3) presents opportunities for students to work on the course materials and their research projects with each other...**students can even complete the weekly quizzes together!**

- 2) **2% Attend the USC Archaeology Center Field Trip** – As part of the course assignments, students are required to attend the USC Archaeology Center during their regularly scheduled lab/discussion section on **November 3**. Students who are unable to attend may instead complete the **extra credit assignment** described in this syllabus (below) as an alternative to the field trip.
- 3) **8% Weekly Quizzes** – find on Brightspace under ACTIVITIES>QUIZZES and complete by 7:00pm on Fridays of the current week, unless otherwise noted in the COURSE SCHEDULE (see below). Quizzes are posted at least week in advance.
 - You can take the quiz as many times as you like before the deadline to get the grade you want/need.
 - **PRO TIP!! Take the quiz before you do the weekly readings and other preparatory work so you know what to look for...then take it again after you complete your weekly assignments to improve your grade if need be.**
 - You can work collaboratively with other students on the quizzes...e.g. during lecture sessions.
 - While you could just get the answers from another student, the point of the quizzes is to make sure you have the information you need to do well on the exams. The multiple-choice and true/false sections of the exams will come straight from the quizzes, so the better you actually know the readings and films, the better you will do on the exams.
 - The three (3) lowest grades, including 0s for skipping a quiz any given week, will be dropped for the final weekly-quiz grade average calculation.
 - No make-up quizzes will be available because the answers to the quizzes will be posted after the due date/time (in the CONTENT section of BRIGHTSPACE as PDF documents) for you to access to prepare for exams. If you miss more than three quizzes, you can do the extra credit assignment to make up any lost points.
- 4) **40% Midterm & Final Exams** [20% each] (online, via Brightspace under ACTIVITIES>QUIZZES) – More information will be sent out about the exams during the semester.
 - Exams will be online (open book and open notes) and the final exam is **NOT CUMULATIVE**.
 - NOTE: OSAS students will automatically have their extra time added to the first part of the exam (if your paperwork has been submitted to the instructor at least two weeks before the exam).
 - All rules regarding plagiarism and AI use apply to the exam essay questions. See the sections on 'Plagiarism' & 'AI Use' below for more information.
 - NOTE: While studying together for the exam is encouraged, **it is expected that you take the exams on your own**. While the exams are open, you should not discuss the exam with anyone, seek answers from other students while taking the exam, or ask other students who have already taken the exam questions about the exam.
 - You CAN use your notes, any of the course materials, and even look up information online; but you will need to refrain from logging onto chat/discussion/messaging apps while the exam periods are open.
 - If you share information with other students or seek out answers to questions from other students (this includes being on chat and 'passively' getting information about the exam) while the exam window is open, you will receive a 0 on the exam.

- **MIDTERM EXAM (1 hour & 20 minutes)** – see the course schedule below for date/time

- 20-25 multiple choice & true/false questions
 - Utilize the weekly quizzes (most of the questions will come directly from the weekly quizzes), lectures, readings, & films, and study questions (in the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS) to prepare for this section of the exam.
- 2 essay questions
 - Utilize the lab section exercises & discussions, lectures, readings, & films, and study questions (in the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS) to prepare for this section of the exam.
 - Suggested length that an average student needs to properly answer a short essay is approximately 500-800 words PER ESSAY QUESTION, but note that credit is based on content quality, use of professional language (specific to anthropology & archaeology), readability, having specific connections to the course materials [readings, films, lectures, discussions, etc.], and completeness & cogency, not word count.
 - From your answers, I want to be confident that you have been completing the assignments and have been through all of the course materials...show me that you have taken this course, in particular. It will be clear if you have not been keeping up with the course materials and/or not participating in lab sections.

- Because generative AI can readily produce large amounts of information, simply providing more content does not demonstrate learning. High-quality exam responses synthesize relevant evidence rather than compiling it. Students should focus on answering the question directly by integrating course concepts, examples, and terminology into a coherent argument that demonstrates an understanding of how the material fits together, rather than presenting disconnected facts or exhaustive summaries.
- **SEE ALSO THE AI USE INFORMATION BELOW, which is important for how I grade everything in this course.**

• **FINAL EXAM (2 hours)** – see the course schedule below for date/time

- 15-20 multiple choice & true/false questions
 - Utilize the weekly quizzes (most of the questions will come directly from the weekly quizzes), lectures, readings, & films, and study questions (in the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS) to prepare for this section of the exam.
- 3 essay questions
 - Utilize the lab section exercises & discussions, lectures, readings, & films, and study questions (in the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS) to prepare for this section of the exam.
 - Suggested length that an average student needs to properly answer a short essay is approximately 500-800 words PER ESSAY QUESTION, but note that credit is based on content quality, use of professional language (specific to anthropology & archaeology), readability, having specific connections to the course materials [readings, films, lectures, discussions, etc.], and completeness & cogency, not word count.
 - From your answers, I want to be confident that you have been completing the assignments and have been through all of the course materials...show me that you have taken this course, in particular. It will be clear if you have not been keeping up with the course materials and/or not participating in lab sections.
 - Because generative AI can readily produce large amounts of information, simply providing more content does not demonstrate learning. High-quality exam responses synthesize relevant evidence rather than compiling it. Students should focus on answering the question directly by integrating course concepts, examples, and terminology into a coherent argument that demonstrates an understanding of how the material fits together, rather than presenting disconnected facts or exhaustive summaries.
 - **SEE ALSO THE AI USE INFORMATION BELOW, which is important for how I grade everything in this course.**

5) **35% Analytical Case-Study (2 research design worksheets + 2 peer-review exercises + 1 final paper)** – see the ‘final paper instructions’ for more detailed information; and find the ‘research design’ & ‘peer-review’ worksheet templates on Brightspace under CONTENT & **see the course schedule below for due dates**. More information to come during the semester about analytical case studies, research designs, and peer-reviews.

- **1% = completion/submission of the Research Design Worksheet 1 (TOPIC)** (submit via Brightspace>ACTIVITIES)
- **2% = completion of the Discussion Board Peer-Review workshop 1 (TOPIC)**
 1. Make sure you have posted YOUR RESEARCH DESIGN WORKSHEET #1 VERBIAGE to the DISCUSSION BOARD (under ACTIVITIES in the proper thread), which **SHOULD HAVE ALREADY BEEN COMPLETED per the Research Design Worksheet #1 instructions**.
 2. COMMENT ON 3 OTHER STUDENT’S WORKSHEET 1 VERBIAGE THREADS on the DISCUSSION BOARD (under ACTIVITIES) using the questions provided in the ‘peer-review 1’ worksheet (TEMPLATE under CONTENT).
 3. **SUBMIT A STUDENT COMMENT LIST** (the document should include the name of each student you reviewed, along with your comments).
 - Submit under ACTIVITIES>ASSIGNMENTS on Brightspace.
 - **ALL 3 parts must be completed to receive credit for the workshop. No exceptions.**

- **1% = completion/submission of the Research Design Worksheet 2 (OPENING PARAGRAPH & BIBLIOGRAPHY)** (submit via Brightspace>ACTIVITIES)
- **2% = completion of the Discussion Board Peer-Review workshop 2 (OPENING PARAGRAPH & BIBLIOGRAPHY)**
 1. Make sure you have posted YOUR RESEARCH DESIGN WORKSHEET #2 VERBIAGE to the DISCUSSION BOARD (under ACTIVITIES in the proper thread), which **SHOULD HAVE ALREADY BEEN COMPLETED per the Research Design Worksheet #2 instructions**.
 2. COMMENT ON 3 OTHER STUDENT’S WORKSHEET 2 VERBIAGE THREADS on the DISCUSSION BOARD (under ACTIVITIES) using the questions provided in the ‘peer-review 2’ worksheet (TEMPLATE under CONTENT).
 3. **SUBMIT A STUDENT COMMENT LIST** (the document should include the name of each student you reviewed, along with your comments).
 - Submit under ACTIVITIES>ASSIGNMENTS on Brightspace.
 - **ALL 3 parts must be completed to receive credit for the workshop. No exceptions.**

- **29% = final paper submission (submit via BRIGHTSPACE>ACTIVITIES)**
 - You can petition for an extension on your final paper, by completing the protocol outlined below in the LATE SUBMISSION POLICY SECTION before the posted due date, but note that ALL COURSE ASSIGNMENTS, including your final paper must be submitted by 11:59pm on the last day of study days before exams begin to receive credit.
 - **NOTE: The instructor will not look over whole drafts for commenting, but will look over specific sections, if you have specific questions. Make sure to get your draft sections in for comment early because the queue for comments becomes longer the closer we get to the deadline. To this end, you may or may not get comments back before the deadline if your draft section is sent less than a week before the due date/time. Continue working on your assignment and do not wait on a response to complete and submit your work.**

AI USE

Within this class, you are welcome to use AI. However, you should note that all large language models have a tendency to make up incorrect facts and fake citations, data modeling tends to produce inaccurate outputs, and image generation is usually almost completely (and many times offensively) wrong. **In this course, you are fully responsible for the accuracy of all content you submit, including factual claims, interpretations, and representations of evidence, regardless of whether the material was written by you or generated with the assistance of an AI tool or other external source.** Fabrication, falsification, or distortion of evidence violates USC's definitions of academic dishonesty, whether produced manually or via AI tools.

AI tools are an expected and legitimate part of the research and writing process in this course. However, they must be used as **partners in thinking and drafting, not as producers of your work.** AI can help summarize, organize, or clarify information, but it cannot replace your analytical labor, interpretive judgment, or engagement with course materials.

For exam essays and case study assignments (including the final paper), **I am not looking for summaries. I am looking for evidence of nuanced understanding,** demonstrated through your ability to work across multiple types of data, evaluate their relationships, and explain *how and why* those data matter. **Strong work shows synthesis, comparison, and interpretation...not surface-level restatement.**

Because generative AI can readily produce large amounts of information, **simply providing more content does not demonstrate learning.** **High-quality work synthesizes relevant evidence rather than compiling it.** You should focus on integrating course concepts, examples, and terminology into coherent analyses that demonstrate an understanding of how the material fits together, rather than presenting disconnected facts or exhaustive summaries.

This level of analysis can only come from sustained engagement with the course: completing the readings, watching and reflecting on course materials, participating in discussion, and thoughtfully working through the study questions. In short, meaningful scholarship requires **real human intellectual labor, not automated output.** AI may support that process, but it cannot replace it. This means you should engage with AI tools to brainstorm, do spelling and grammar checks, refine, clarify, or explore ideas, **but the final product must clearly reflect your own holistic and nuanced thinking, voice, and judgment.**

Your work should demonstrate clear, original analysis; strong research; coherent writing; minimal grammar issues; authentic understanding of your topic; and **avoid AI-style vagueness, repetition, superficiality, and fabricated details.** I will be looking for **holistic & research informed thinking, well-structured organization, detailed and varied evidence and data sources, personal voice, and human judgment throughout;** and considering the help AI can provide, **your work must be extremely well written, free of spelling and grammatical errors, and follow all formatting and prompt instructions.**

AI-generated content often lacks specificity, substitutes clichés for insight, and fabricates sources or examples. In contrast, human writing demonstrates nuance, context awareness, meaningful synthesis, and intentional structure. These are not only academic expectations, but they are also professional and transferable skills you will need in any discipline or industry moving forward. In addition, **your work should clearly show active participation and engagement with the specific themes, methodologies, and theoretical foundations we have explored in this course.** Your writing should reflect that you have taken *this* particular course; AI cannot replicate that level of engagement or familiarity with our shared discussions, readings, and exercises.

I have been using AI extensively for many years now and can easily recognize work that has not been properly vetted or authored by a human. **Submissions that over-rely on AI (without thoughtful engagement, editing, and human input) will lose points for failing to meet expectations of depth, accuracy, cogency, and professionalism.**

AI-generated or heavily AI-assisted writing is often identifiable through the following patterns:

- **Lack of contextual specificity:** Writing relies on broad or abstract statements about “archaeology,” “the past,” or “human behavior” without grounding claims in concrete data, clearly defined case studies, time periods, geographic locations, or material evidence.
- **Generic or formulaic phrasing:** Language sounds polished but interchangeable, using predictable academic constructions that could apply to many topics without demonstrating focused engagement with the particular materials, readings, or examples addressed in the course.
- **Absence of analytical positioning:** The response summarizes concepts without showing how the writer is thinking through the evidence; there is little indication of uncertainty, interpretation, tradeoffs, or decision-making that characterize real archaeological analysis.
- **Detachment from empirical evidence:** Claims are not clearly supported by specific artifacts, features, datasets, figures, or assigned sources, or they include inaccuracies that suggest the material was synthesized rather than examined closely.

To this end, **AI tools may be used only for limited support tasks (such as brainstorming, outlining, or proofreading for clarity).** They may **not** be used to generate substantive content, including descriptions, observations, interpretations, arguments, or comparisons. **Archaeological writing requires engagement with specific data, case studies, and contexts that must come from your own analysis or points will be deducted, whether the disengagement comes from a lack of participation or overuse of AI...both read the same.**

Effective archaeological writing should read as situated, data-driven, and interpretive, demonstrating that arguments emerge from direct engagement with archaeological evidence and course materials, **not from generalized summaries or automated synthesis.**

EXTRA CREDIT²

- The following assignment is worth up to 3 extra credit COURSE POINTS (so, up to +3 course points for a 90% or higher grade on your extra credit submission added to your final grade, which will bump you a whole letter grade; e.g. A- to an A), and can be turned in any time during the semester until 11:59pm on the last day of study days (see the [COURSE SCHEDULE for the exact date](#)).
 - Submit the extra credit assignment via the Brightspace ACTIVITIES>ASSIGNMENTS section (use the proper folder) by the deadline.
 - Follow all the directions; complete all the prompts AND use the correct format...or you will lose points.
 - Make sure to look over the [PLAGIARISM](#) and [AI USE](#) sections of the syllabus.

Museums, Materiality, and Meaning: A Comparative Analysis of Three NHM Exhibitions

Overview

For this extra-credit assignment, you will engage directly with three Natural History Museum exhibitions (two in-person and one online) and produce a single, integrated comparative, reflexive analysis. This assignment is designed to assess your ability to critically evaluate material culture, exhibition design, and interpretive narratives, while explicitly connecting museum practice to the themes and frameworks of this course. You should **compare, contrast, and critically reflect across all three exhibitions**, drawing on your own embodied experience as a visitor to these exhibits and as an archaeology student in this course.

Exhibitions (you must visit all three):

1. Visible Vault – Natural History Museum (in person)
2. Becoming Los Angeles – Natural History Museum (in person)
3. The Fabric of Community: Tapa and Woven Mats from the Pacific Islands – NHM online exhibition
<https://nhm.org/experience-nhm/exhibitions-natural-history-museum/fabric-community>

Requirements

- **Format:**
 - Your paper should be written as a **single, cohesive essay** that compares and contrasts all three exhibits, utilizing the following (required) sections below, in the order in which they are presented.
 - You must address all of the prompts below for your paper to fully meet the expectations of this exercise.
 - Your paper should be at least 1,200 words.
 - List the word count at the top of your document.
 - You must include at least 1 photo of yourself at each in-person exhibit.
 - Turn in the assignment no later than the final due date and time (see the COURSE SCHEDULE for the exact date). No exceptions.
- **Output Expectations Overview:**
 - Your response should **show an appropriate level of depth, clarity, engagement, and analytical precision for the course**. Your response should demonstrate **meaningful engagement with the course materials and the museum exhibits**; offering interpretations and connections that reflect thoughtful consideration.
 - Each sentence should contribute new information, add to the depth and breadth of the analysis, and presents specific examples that advance the response rather than repeating previously stated content, just in different ways. **Answers that are technically accurate but limited in scope, development, or analytic contribution do not fully meet the expectations of this prompt.**
- **SECTIONS (required):**
 1. **Types of Exhibition Materials, Presentation of Materials, and the Visitor Experience***
 - Briefly describe each exhibit's organization; how is it set up for the visitor to move through the exhibit?
 - Identify the **types of materials** featured in each exhibit (objects, specimens, textiles, archival documents, digital media, etc.).
 - Compare how material culture is used/presented differently (or similarly!) across the three exhibits.
 - Examples may include, but are not limited to:
 - How does physical proximity to objects (in the in-person exhibits) shape interpretation compared to the online exhibit?
 - Does the layout or lighting shape the experience? How so?
 - Is the layout in chronological order? ...if not, how is it organized to move through?
 - Identify **at least one limitation or problem** in each exhibition.
 - These may include issues of representation, accessibility, narrative framing, omissions, layout, lighting, signage, etc.
 - Compare how these issues manifest differently across physical and digital exhibition spaces.

² See the FAQ section of the syllabus...doing the extra credit assignment is linked to my final grade bumping policies.

- In your opinion, which exhibitions most successfully communicate meaning through material evidence, and why?

**This section should clearly reflect your personal experience as a visitor and should not be a generalized commentary.*

2. Learning Outcomes & Knowledge Production

- What did you learn from each exhibition that you did *not* already know? Be specific...

3. Course Connections*

- Address the following questions, and make sure to make **explicit connections between the concepts, case studies, reading/film materials, or discussions from this course and the museum exhibits**:
 - How did the objects, specimens, or materials on display function as archaeological evidence rather than simply as “museum objects”?
 - Where did you notice the limits of material evidence; in other words...what questions could the objects help answer, and what questions remain unresolved?
 - Explain how the exhibitions illustrate the kinds of interpretive choices archaeologists must make when working with partial, incomplete, or curated material records. Be specific.
 - Examples might include (but are not limited to):
 - Understanding the lived experiences of people in the past
 - Understanding how cultures change over time
 - Material vs. documentary data
 - Representation and voice
 - Heritage and authenticity
 - Museums as sites of authenticity and cultural interpretation

**Vague references to “things we talked about in class” or “the stuff in the exhibit” will not receive full credit, you need to be specific.*

EMAIL

I will do my best to respond to emails within 24 hours during the week. I may not be able to return emails on weekends or after 6:00pm, although this is generally not the case. Please note that awaiting my response is never an excuse for not completing assignments described in the syllabus.

LATE SUBMISSION POLICIES

NOTE: All course materials must be submitted by the end of study days at 11:59pm/the day before exams begin to receive credit (SEE THE COURSE SCHEDULE BELOW FOR THE EXACT DATE). **If you are struggling, get ahold of me sooner, rather than later if you need help – and note that in extreme circumstances you have the option to take an incomplete. If you need to consider an incomplete option or emergency withdrawal, first contact your advisor, and check out the USC registrar’s website for more information to understand all facets of these options.**

Weekly recurring assignments cannot be submitted late, which includes the weekly quizzes.

Course assignments (the final paper and research design worksheets & peer reviews) can be submitted late, but 10 points will be deducted (e.g. 100%-90%) for every day the assignment is late (+1 minute to 24 hours late = a 10-point deduction, and the same for every +1 minute to 24 hours thereafter).

- **NOTE:** Doing an assignment at the last minute and then having submission issues which makes your assignment late, is a time management issue. You should allow time for any issues that may arise and not plan on submitting your work at the last second because late is late and there will still be a points deduction.
- **No-penalty, late-submission entitlements can be given**, but only **in very extreme circumstances**. You are given plenty of time to work on and submit your assignments. It is your responsibility to manage your time, but I know that sometimes things happen that are out of your control.
 - To this end, you can get approved for a late submission entitlement by:
 1. notifying the instructor of the reason/s for your request **no less than 24 hours prior to the official deadline**,
 2. providing paperwork or proof for your case in accordance with USC requirements for excused absences or late submission allowances, and
 3. **providing a date and time you will submit your assignment, which should not be more than 3 days**.
 - If approved, late-assignment deductions will not begin to accrue until after your individually approved deadline.

COURSE SCHEDULE

Please note that the following schedule is a high-level outline of the course, which lists only the readings, major assignments, exam dates, and weekly course themes & foci. So, make sure to **also read over the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS in the CONTENT section of BRIGHTSPACE** prior to attending classes each week for more information, announcements, and upcoming deadline reminders. Weekly module instructions will be posted at least week in advance.

DO NOT FORGET TO TAKE THE WEEKLY QUIZ, due Fridays -unless otherwise noted- by 7:00pm.

MOD 1 Week 1 (AUG. 24-30)	Welcome! Course overview & instructor introduction.	
	See the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS [in the CONTENT section of BRIGHTSPACE] for more detail about weekly preparatory activities and assignments to be done PRIOR to attending classes each week. ONLY LAB SECTIONS THIS WEEK...NO TUES/THURS LECTURE SESSIONS	NO QUIZ THIS WEEK NO Tuesday lecture session this week NO Thursday lecture session this week
MOD 2 Week 2 (AUG. 31-SEPT. 6)	The Principles of Archaeology & What is Anthropology?	
	See the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS [in the CONTENT section of BRIGHTSPACE] for more detail about weekly preparatory activities and assignments to be done PRIOR to attending classes each week.	
MOD 3 Week 3 (SEPT. 7-13)	The History of Archaeology, Our Earliest Ancestors, Data Sampling Strategies, and Excavation Types	
	See the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS [in the CONTENT section of BRIGHTSPACE] for more detail about weekly preparatory activities and assignments to be done PRIOR to attending classes each week.	
MOD 4 Week 4 (SEPT. 14-20)	FILM DAY 1 – Native North Americans ONLY THURSDAY LECTURE SESSION THIS WEEK ...NO LAB SECTION or TUESDAY LECTURE SESSION THIS WEEK, instead watch the assigned recorded lecture and full-length films in addition to the other tasks in this week's module. We will review the films during Thursday's class.	SEE THE WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS for more information, including links to the required films.
	See the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS [in the CONTENT section of BRIGHTSPACE] for more detail about weekly preparatory activities and assignments to be done PRIOR to attending classes each week.	NO lab section this week NO Tuesday lecture session this week
MOD 5 Week 5 (SEPT. 21-27)	Making a Living-Foraging to Agriculture & The Paleolithic	
	See the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS [in the CONTENT section of BRIGHTSPACE] for more detail about weekly preparatory activities and assignments to be done PRIOR to attending classes each week.	RESEARCH DESIGN WORKSHEET 1 DUE by Friday @ 7pm. The worksheet template is available in the CONTENT section of Brightspace. **see the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS for more detail about this assignment** **see the late submission policy in the syllabus for more information**

MOD 6 Week 6 (SEPT. 28-OCT. 4)	Ancient Mesoamerica	
	See the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS [in the CONTENT section of BRIGHTSPACE] for more detail about weekly preparatory activities and assignments to be done PRIOR to attending classes each week.	RESEARCH DESIGN DISCUSSION BOARD PEER-REVIEW WORKSHOP 1 DUE by Friday @ 7pm. The worksheet template is available in the CONTENT section of Brightspace. **see the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS for more detail about this assignment** **see the late submission policy in the syllabus for more information**
MOD 7 Week 7 (OCT. 5-11)	Thinking Critically About Context Building Behaviors & the Archaeology of Burning Man	FALL BREAK
	See the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS [in the CONTENT section of BRIGHTSPACE] for more detail about weekly preparatory activities and assignments to be done PRIOR to attending classes each week. We will be doing a QUIZ BOWL in lab section to prep for the exam, so please attend! The winning team/s will receive an extra credit point on the upcoming exam. <u>ONLY LAB SECTIONS and TUES LECTURE SESSION THIS WEEK...no THURS LECTURE SESSION THIS WEEK - FALL BREAK</u>	NO QUIZ THIS WEEK NO Thursday lecture session this week (FALL BREAK)
MOD 8 Week 8 (OCT. 12-18)	(ONLINE) MIDTERM EXAM Tuesday, October 13th – 2pm to 3:20pm ...during what is usually Tuesday's lecture session Access the exam via the ACTIVITIES section of Brightspace under QUIZZES, which will become active/visible at 2pm on OCTOBER 13th.	NO QUIZ THIS WEEK NO CLASSES THIS WEEK
MOD 9 Week 9 (OCT. 19-25)	FILM DAY 2 – STATES AND EMPIRES IN ASIA & AFRICA <u>ONLY THURSDAY LECTURE SESSION THIS WEEK</u> ...NO LAB SECTION or TUESDAY LECTURE SESSION THIS WEEK...Instead watch the assigned full-length films in addition to the other tasks in this week's module. We will review the film during Thursday's class.	SEE THE WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS for more information, including a link to the required film.
	See the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS [in the CONTENT section of BRIGHTSPACE] for more detail about weekly preparatory activities and assignments to be done PRIOR to attending classes each week.	NO lab section this week NO Tuesday lecture session this week
MOD 10 Week 10 (OCT. 26-NOV. 1)	States and Empires in Asia and Africa (continued)	
	See the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS [in the CONTENT section of BRIGHTSPACE] for more detail about weekly preparatory activities and assignments to be done PRIOR to attending classes each week.	

MOD 11 Week 11 (NOV. 2-8)	South America & Prehistoric Europe, Utilizing Documents Wisely, What is 'Ethnohistory'?, & The Importance of Ceramics in Archaeology	FIELD TRIP TO THE USC ARCHAEOLOGY RESEARCH CENTER
	See the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS [in the CONTENT section of BRIGHTSPACE] for more detail about weekly preparatory activities and assignments to be done PRIOR to attending classes each week. ...for your lab/discussion this week, meet at the USC RESEARCH CENTER (ACB 330). NOTE: We will not hold a lecture on Tuesday, but we WILL hold the lecture session on Thursday.	LAB SECTIONS ARE AT THE ARCH RESEARCH CENTER THIS WEEK do not be late...this is for course credit and the laboratory curators have spent a lot of time preparing for your visit, please be respectful of their time. NO Tuesday lecture session this week
MOD 12 Week 12 (NOV. 9-15)	Putting It All Together: From Research Questions to Research Outcomes	
	See the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS [in the CONTENT section of BRIGHTSPACE] for more detail about weekly preparatory activities and assignments to be done PRIOR to attending classes each week. NOTE: THURSDAY'S LECTURE SESSION IS ONLINE THIS WEEK (connect via USC zoom via BRIGHTSPACE) This will be an open session where students can ask any questions about the final paper/case study and final exam. Note that to receive attendance credit, you must attend the entire class, which is documented via ZOOM. Even if you don't ask any questions, hearing what others are asking and the answers to those questions will still be of help to you as you finish up the semester.	Thursday's lecture session is on ZOOM this week RESEARCH DESIGN WORKSHEET 2 DUE by Friday @ 7pm. The worksheet template is available in the CONTENT section of Brightspace. **see the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS for more detail about this assignment** **see the late submission policy in the syllabus for more information**
MOD 13 Week 13 (NOV. 16-22)	FILM DAY 3 – Authenticity, Tourism, & Heritage Studies ONLY LAB SECTIONS & TUESDAY LECTURE SESSION THIS WEEK ...NO THURSDAY LECTURE SESSION THIS WEEK, instead watch the assigned full-length films in addition to the other tasks in this week's module. We will review the film when we return from Thanksgiving break.	SEE THE WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS for more information, including a link to the required films.
	See the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS [in the CONTENT section of BRIGHTSPACE] for more detail about weekly preparatory activities and assignments to be done PRIOR to attending classes each week.	NO lab section this week NO Tuesday lecture session this week NO Thursday lecture session this week RESEARCH DESIGN DISCUSSION BOARD PEER-REVIEW WORKSHOP 2 DUE by Friday @ 7pm. The worksheet template is available in the CONTENT section of Brightspace. **see the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS for more detail about this assignment** **see the late submission policy in the syllabus for more information**
MOD 14 Week 14 (NOV. 23-29)	THANKSGIVING BREAK NO CLASSES THIS WEEK	NO QUIZ THIS WEEK NO CLASSES THIS WEEK

MOD 15 Week 15 (NOV. 30-DEC. 6)	The Future of Archaeology	
	See the WEEKLY MODULE INSTRUCTIONS [in the CONTENT section of BRIGHTSPACE] for more detail about weekly preparatory activities and assignments to be done PRIOR to attending classes each week. We will be doing a QUIZ BOWL in lab section to prep for the exam, so please attend! The winning team/s will receive an extra credit point on the upcoming exam.	NO QUIZ THIS WEEK ANALYTICAL CASE STUDY DUE FRIDAY by 7:00pm **see the late submission policy in the syllabus for more information**
FINAL EXAM	(ONLINE) FINAL EXAM THURSDAY, DECEMBER 10th – 2:00pm to 4:00pm Access the exam via the ACTIVITIES section of Brightspace under QUIZZES, which will become active/visible at 2:00pm on DECEMBER 10th.	DON'T FORGET: ALL ASSIGNMENTS, including EXTRA CREDIT SUBMISSIONS AND YOUR FINAL PAPER MUST BE SUBMITTED NO LATER THAN 11:59PM ON TUESDAY, DECEMBER 8th (end of study days) TO BE COUNTED FOR THE COURSE – NO EXCEPTIONS.

Want an A or a B?NOTES ON HOW TO DO WELL IN THIS COURSE

- **Turn your work in on time.** There are, of course, ways to get extension accommodations, but make sure to know the protocol (outlined above) for your request for late submission to be considered. Timeliness is just as important as citing correctly, writing well, and participation in this course...**don't expect to get the same grade as someone who met deadlines, which simply would not be fair.**
- **Strive to make your work better than average.** Does your work show academic and creative bravery in response to instructions? Are you asking complex questions and being comparative (e.g. looking at more than one line of data) in order to argue your point? Do you have solid references and citations? **Have you done work that is interesting and challenging to a reader that has read, quite literally, 1,000s of (basically) the same paper?** (PRO TIP!! Know your audience)
- **Be present & engaged.** Prepare for and attend classes & participate in small group and seminar style discussions & exercises, keep up with your readings, and do your assignments...in the spirit in which the course was designed. Most of you will not become archaeologists, but for one semester, you can train as one! ...which not everyone can say they have done. You might even be surprised how well the anthropological and archaeological toolkits translate into any discipline and allow for complex problem solving using both qualitative & quantitative data and deductive & inductive research methods & reasoning.
- **Explore topics that interest you outside of the course.** Your work will be better if you explore archaeology through themes that are already on your radar. While archaeology may be new to you, economics, health, sports, art, etc, might not be...and all of these themes have a past that can be critically explored.
 - PRO TIP!! If you are required to take courses outside of your major, why not research something that relates directly to your future interests? If you want to go into the home healthcare field, why not study the history of your field for your research project? Save time and do work that will benefit you and move your own personal educational goals forward, no matter the course.
- **Embrace being a little confused sometimes.** Unlike most of your university level courses, very few students have ever had any anthropological or archaeological training. You will get foundational training...you do not need to worry that you currently know very little about this subject. Follow the plan and do the exercises and assignments, in the spirit in which they were designed, and you will learn a great deal about archaeology and anthropology in a short period of time.
- **Use AI thoughtfully and responsibly.** In this course, you are **expected to use AI as a research and writing partner, not a producer.** AI can help you brainstorm, check grammar and spelling, clarify ideas, and explore directions, but the final product must reflect your own thinking & voice, show evidence of deep-research & topic exploration, and include cogent, data-driven interpretations. Your work must be detailed, well-organized, and free of errors **because with AI support, the writing bar is higher.** You should also demonstrate clear engagement with this course's themes, methods, and assigned materials, which are things AI cannot do well. Importantly, I've used AI extensively for years and can easily recognize when a student has not taken the time to thoughtfully engage with or refine AI-generated content. **Over-reliance on AI, without meaningful editing, critical thinking, or personal input, will result in a lower grade. Use AI to enhance and sharpen your ideas, not to substitute for them.** (see more detail about AI USE in the AI USE SECTION above)
- **Know that the I will not respond to bullying or unreasonable (or unethical) requests that give you an unfair advantage over other students; this includes 'guilt bullying' and 'grade grubbing' at the end of the semester.** I give you many options for completing your work, allow plenty of time to work on your final paper throughout the course, offer extra credit (see below), am respectful of your busy schedule in the way I have designed the course, and I am very clear about my grading criteria. **If you are having issues, getting behind, or need assistance, talk to me as soon as possible because I want to help...**but, don't get into a situation at the end of the semester where you are looking for any way possible to get an extra point here or there, this creates a hostile environment for both the student and the instructor and I (literally) will not respond to this type of behavior.

PLAGIARISM – presenting someone else’s ideas as your own, either verbatim or recast in your own words – is a serious academic offense with serious consequences. Please familiarize yourself with the discussion of plagiarism in *SCampus* in Part B, Section 11, “Behavior Violating University Standards” policy.usc.edu/scampus-part-b. Other forms of academic dishonesty are equally unacceptable. See additional information in *SCampus* and university policies on scientific misconduct <http://policy.usc.edu/scientific-misconduct>.

When submitting your written assignments, Turn-it-In will give you a plagiarism score before you officially submit your document, which you should look over before you upload your document to double-check your work. Note that, many times, this score is overinflated because a student HAS quoted an author, but used quotes/cited properly and it will be clear that individual was not plagiarizing. I will look at each score, individually, to do my own assessment. **This policy applies to all written assignments, including essay questions on exams.**

Please note that while I understand that some mistakes can be made (e.g. using quotes, but forgetting the in-text citation/using language that is similar across the themes you are researching/honest mistakes), cutting and pasting whole sections from other authors or Wikipedia (yes, I have had entire Wikipedia articles cut and pasted into a document, links and all, and turned in as a final paper...more than once) will result in 1) failing the course and 2) your case escalated to the USC Office of Academic Integrity. ***I will not contact you directly if you have purposefully plagiarized your work, instead you will hear directly from Administration.***

- ***NOTE: If you are struggling, get ahold of me sooner, rather than later if you need help – and note that in extreme circumstances you have the option to take an incomplete. If you need to consider an incomplete option or withdrawal, first contact your advisor, and check out the USC registrar’s website for more information to understand all facets of this option.***

While use of AI writing platforms (like chatGPT) is helpful during the research and writing process, your final product **MUST BE YOUR OWN WORK**. Students can ask questions, request explanations, or seek guidance from AI platforms, which can be especially helpful for students who have limited resources, face barriers to education, need some inspiration to get past a writing block, or need extra support with writing and word choice.

- Although AI writing platforms offer tools for generating texts for this class, when they take your place they can preempt or inhibit the development of your writing and critical thinking.
- You should never attempt to present or include content created by others, including generative AI as your own. Attempting to take credit for content generated by AI or others without proper acknowledgement is a violation of USC’s policies and standards for academic integrity and can result in disciplinary action.
 - ***NOTE: Submitting work generated wholly or partially by an AI writing platform is considered plagiarism, and violations will be treated accordingly.***

LAND ACKNOWLEDGEMENT – USC is located on Pimu’gna (Santa Catalina Island) and Tovaangar, which are the sacred and traditional lands of the first native peoples, the Tongva (Gabrielino), who are the original stewards of this land and continue in this role today.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY – The University of Southern California is a learning community committed to developing successful scholars and researchers dedicated to the pursuit of knowledge and the dissemination of ideas. Academic misconduct, which includes any act of dishonesty in the production or submission of academic work, compromises the integrity of the person who commits the act and can impugn the perceived integrity of the entire university community. It stands in opposition to the university’s mission to research, educate, and contribute productively to our community and the world.

All students are expected to submit assignments that represent their own original work, and that have been prepared specifically for the course or section for which they have been submitted. You may not submit work written by others or “recycle” work prepared for other courses without obtaining written permission from the instructor(s).

Other violations of academic integrity include, but are not limited to, cheating, plagiarism, fabrication (e.g., falsifying data), collusion, knowingly assisting others in acts of academic dishonesty, and any act that gains or is intended to gain an unfair academic advantage.

The impact of academic dishonesty is far-reaching and is considered a serious offense against the university. All incidences of academic misconduct will be reported to the Office of Academic Integrity and could result in outcomes such as failure on the assignment, failure in the course, suspension, or even expulsion from the university.

For more information about academic integrity see [the student handbook](#) or the [Office of Academic Integrity’s website](#), and university policies on [Research and Scholarship Misconduct](#). Please ask your instructor if you are unsure what constitutes unauthorized assistance on an exam or assignment, or what information requires citation and/or attribution.

STUDENTS AND DISABILITY ACCOMODATIONS - USC welcomes students with disabilities into all of the University's educational programs. [The Office of Student Accessibility Services \(OSAS\)](#) is responsible for the determination of appropriate accommodations for students who encounter disability-related barriers. Once a student has completed the OSAS process (registration, initial appointment, and submitted documentation) and accommodations are determined to be reasonable and appropriate, a Letter of Accommodation (LOA) will be available to generate for each course. The LOA must be given to each course instructor by the student and followed up with a discussion. This should be done as early in the semester as possible as accommodations are not retroactive. More information can be found at osas.usc.edu. You may contact OSAS at (213) 740-0776 or via email at osasfrontdesk@usc.edu.

SUPPORT SYSTEMS

[Academic Coaching: USC Kortschak Center](#) – (213) 740 7884 – 10am-4pm MON-FRI

Free academic coaching, focused on helping you develop essential skills for success in college. Your coach will work with you to improve your time management, study strategies, and organizational skills.

[Counseling and Mental Health](#) - (213) 740-9355 – 24/7 on call

Free and confidential mental health treatment for students, including short-term psychotherapy, group counseling, stress fitness workshops, and crisis intervention.

[988 Suicide and Crisis Lifeline](#) - 988 for both calls and text messages – 24/7 on call

The 988 Suicide and Crisis Lifeline (formerly known as the National Suicide Prevention Lifeline) provides free and confidential emotional support to people in suicidal crisis or emotional distress 24 hours a day, 7 days a week, across the United States. The Lifeline is comprised of a national network of over 200 local crisis centers, combining custom local care and resources with national standards and best practices. The new, shorter phone number makes it easier for people to remember and access mental health crisis services (though the previous 1 (800) 273-8255 number will continue to function indefinitely) and represents a continued commitment to those in crisis.

[Relationship and Sexual Violence Prevention Services \(RSVP\)](#) - (213) 740-9355(WELL) – 24/7 on call

Free and confidential therapy services, workshops, and training for situations related to gender- and power-based harm (including sexual assault, intimate partner violence, and stalking).

[Office for Equity, Equal Opportunity, and Title IX \(EEO-TIX\)](#) - (213) 740-5086

Information about how to get help or help someone affected by harassment or discrimination, rights of protected classes, reporting options, and additional resources for students, faculty, staff, visitors, and applicants.

[Reporting Incidents of Bias or Harassment](#) - (213) 740-5086 or (213) 821-8298

Avenue to report incidents of bias, hate crimes, and microaggressions to the Office for Equity, Equal Opportunity, and Title for appropriate investigation, supportive measures, and response.

[The Office of Student Accessibility Services \(OSAS\)](#) - (213) 740-0776

OSAS ensures equal access for students with disabilities through providing academic accommodations and auxiliary aids in accordance with federal laws and university policy.

[USC Campus Support and Intervention](#) - (213) 740-0411

Assists students and families in resolving complex personal, financial, and academic issues adversely affecting their success as a student.

[Diversity, Equity and Inclusion](#) - (213) 740-2101

Information on events, programs and training, the Provost's Diversity and Inclusion Council, Diversity Liaisons for each academic school, chronology, participation, and various resources for students.

[USC Emergency](#) - UPC: (213) 740-4321, HSC: (323) 442-1000 – 24/7 on call

Emergency assistance and avenue to report a crime. Latest updates regarding safety, including ways in which instruction will be continued if an officially declared emergency makes travel to campus infeasible.

[USC Department of Public Safety](#) - UPC: (213) 740-6000, HSC: (323) 442-1200 – 24/7 on call

Non-emergency assistance or information.

[Office of the Ombuds](#) - (213) 821-9556 (UPC) / (323-442-0382 (HSC)

A safe and confidential place to share your USC-related issues with a University Ombuds who will work with you to explore options or paths to manage your concern.

[Occupational Therapy Faculty Practice](#) - (323) 442-2850 or otfp@med.usc.edu

Confidential Lifestyle Redesign services for USC students to support health promoting habits and routines that enhance quality of life and academic performance.